

Module 14: Solutions, Governance, and the Future

Signature Learning Experience

Purpose

The course capstone: each student (or team) develops a complete proposal for a policy, program, or intervention addressing one migration challenge — integrating what the course taught about drivers, data, law, economics, lived experience, and governance. This is the assignment everything else has been building toward.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Summarize the relevant solution landscape before proposing your own (UG 1)
- Identify the stakeholders who decide, benefit, pay, and resist (UG 2)
- Explain the governance level(s) your proposal operates at and why (UG 3)
- Propose an intervention and defend it against informed challenge (UG 4)

Graduate extension

Graduate students produce the full multi-level design: local, national, and international components that reinforce each other, engagement with the Global Compact framework, an implementation timeline, cost logic, risk register, and evaluation framework (Grad 1–2). This is the graduate capstone requirement.

Assignment steps

1. Define the problem precisely: one migration challenge, one affected population, one scale. 'Fix the asylum system' fails this step; 'reduce the work-authorization gap for asylum seekers in state X' passes.
2. Survey what exists: what has been tried for this problem, what the evidence says, and why the gap persists anyway — if you can't explain why it persists, your proposal will repeat someone's failure.
3. Draw on at least four earlier modules explicitly (e.g., driver analysis from Module 4, data from Module 2, legal constraints from Module 9, livelihood evidence from Module 10) and cite where each shaped the design.
4. Build the proposal: what it does, who runs it, what it costs roughly, its legal basis, and its theory of change.
5. Map the politics honestly: who must say yes, who will resist and why, and what makes adoption plausible anyway.
6. Present and defend the proposal in the final session — questions will be adversarial by design. Revise once after the defense and submit the final version.

Deliverables & format

- Final proposal, 2,500–3,000 words (graduate: 5,000+ full multi-level design with implementation and evaluation annexes)
- Two-page executive brief a decision-maker could read alone
- Defense presentation (10 minutes) plus post-defense revision memo noting what changed and why

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Problem definition and evidence base 25%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: problem definition and evidence base is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: problem definition and evidence base is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: problem definition and evidence base is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: problem definition and evidence base is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Integration of course frameworks across modules 25%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: integration of course frameworks across modules goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: integration of course frameworks across modules is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: integration of course frameworks across modules is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: integration of course frameworks across modules is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Feasibility and political realism 25%	Design judgment is excellent: feasibility and political realism is fully addressed — costs, constraints, politics, and failure modes are named honestly and the proposal remains workable anyway.	Design judgment is good: feasibility and political realism is addressed for the major factors, with minor blind spots that would not sink the proposal.	Design judgment is limited: feasibility and political realism is addressed superficially — key constraints or failure modes are ignored, making the proposal fragile.	Design judgment is missing: feasibility and political realism is not addressed; the proposal ignores obvious constraints and would not survive contact with reality.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Defense performance and quality of post-defense revision 25%	Performance under questioning is outstanding: defense performance and quality of post-defense revision shows command of the material, direct engagement with hard questions, and revision that visibly improved the work.	Performance is solid: defense performance and quality of post-defense revision shows good command and reasonable answers to challenges, with revision addressing the main feedback.	Performance is shaky: defense performance and quality of post-defense revision shows incomplete command — questions deflected or answered vaguely, revision cosmetic.	Performance is inadequate: defense performance and quality of post-defense revision shows the student could not explain or defend their own work, and feedback was not incorporated.